

Teaching Statement

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1 Vision

As an economics professor, I have three primary teaching goals, and I tailor my classes toward achieving these goals. The first of these is to establish a deep interest in the subject of economics. As someone who originally did not pursue economics, having envisioned instead a career as a mathematician, it was an economics professor during my undergraduate studies who ignited my passion for the field. What captivated me was how malleable and applicable economics is to understanding the world around us. My aim is to inspire that same passion in my students, helping them see that economics is not just a theoretical subject but a dynamic tool to analyze real-world issues.

The second goal is to inform students about the many ways that economics affects their daily lives, often in ways they may not even realize. I discovered that something as integral as decision-making in fields such as personal finance and public policy could be analyzed and understood through the lens of economics. This was transformative for me. I want my students to leave my courses with the ability to identify the underlying economic forces shaping their world, enabling them to think more critically about the world they inhabit.

The third goal is to create an inclusive, supportive learning environment, in which all students feel empowered to engage with the material without fear of judgment. I strive to foster a classroom that prioritizes mutual respect and encourages intellectual curiosity, allowing students to have the courage to succeed.

To achieve these three goals, I employ a four-step approach to teaching economics.

First, I establish the classroom and my office hours as spaces specifically designed for learning and growth. From the outset, I make it clear that participation is not only welcome, but essential. I encourage students to share their thoughts and ideas, even if their answers may be incorrect. This creates an environment where learning from mistakes is seen as a valuable part of the educational process. Thus, the trust between professor and student is strengthened, facilitating learning.

Second, I focus on building strong foundational knowledge at the beginning of each section

and class. By ensuring that students have a solid grasp of key concepts, they are better equipped to tackle more complex material as the course progresses. This also allows students to take these foundations and think about the underlying mechanisms behind these ideas. One example was when I had students track the price changes of a product of their choice to examine inflation with our own market basket, then compare to government inflation data.

Third, I aim to expand upon these foundations by connecting theory to real-world examples. Economics is all around us, from global trade patterns to everyday consumer choices. By highlighting these connections, I help students understand the relevance of what they are learning and how it applies to the world in which they live. Many of my current students major in fashion design, and framing lessons on supply and demand towards helping them to determine a price to charge for online commissions may help them in the future. Even if students do not continue to pursue economics, I hope they can apply these lessons to their fields of study.

Finally, I encourage students to think beyond conventional economic applications. I challenge them to apply economic ideas in creative ways, such as considering how the tools of economics can be used to solve problems or analyze situations that may not appear to use traditional economic thought. My research on the Affordable Care Act affecting births demonstrates to students how something that may not seem to be an economic decision can follow the theories and methods we develop in class.

Through this approach, I work to establish an interest in economics amongst my students, help relate the ideas of economics to my students, and provide a supporting learning environment for all. With these three goals, I hope to cultivate not only a deeper understanding of economics, but also an enduring curiosity and analytical mindset which students can carry with them into their future endeavors.